

# ZAIRA CHRISTA BARAKAT

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## PROFILE

Oxford-educated strategist completing an MA in Cultural and Creative Industries at King's College London, with a research-led approach built on close analysis, structured argument, and evidence-based decision-making. Directed an independent fashion label from concept to catwalk, managing contracts, stakeholder negotiations, and commercial risk at each stage; and drove a threefold increase in ticket sales for Oxford's flagship fashion even through data-informed strategy. Combines attention to detail with strong client-facing and interpersonal skills, and advanced French. Draws on a lifelong interest in how industries and cultural systems are structured.

## EDUCATION

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| King's College London – MA Cultural and Creative Industries     | 2025 - 2026 |
| University of Oxford, Somerville College – BA (Hons) Music, 2:1 | 2022 - 2025 |

## EXPERIENCE

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| <b>Zaira Christa Fashion Label</b><br><i>Founder and Creative Director</i> | <b>London   2022 - Present</b> |
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- Founded an independent fashion label and brought two seasonal collections from initial concept through to runway presentation, directing all creative, production, and styling decisions independently.
- Built the label's brand identity across digital platforms, producing a portfolio of campaign imagery and editorial content that articulates a distinct creative point of view.

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| <b>The Reach Brasserie</b><br><i>Bar Manager</i> | <b>London   2025 - 2026</b> |
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- Managed day-to-day bar operations in a high-footfall venue, maintaining consistent brand standards across service, supplier relationships, and staff performance.
- Designed and launched a curated seasonal cocktail offering, balancing creative concept development with cost efficiency and commercial viability.

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| <b>Oxford Fashion Gala</b><br><i>Co-Creative Director &amp; Co-Marketing Director</i> | <b>Oxford   2023 - 2025</b> |
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- Appointed to lead the end-to-end creative vision for Oxford's largest annual fashion event, producing a thematically unified show by directing concept development, casting direction, set design, and choreography from brief to live performance.
- Drove a 200% increase in ticket sales year-on-year by designing and executing a multi-platform social campaign that combined curated content, strategic collaborations, and a data-informed posting schedule.
- Delivered a cohesive campaign identity aligned with the Gala's creative vision, coordinating all audience-facing assets, copy, and promotional content across a team of volunteers.

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| <b>Levi Strauss</b><br><i>Stylist</i> | <b>London   2025</b> |
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- Exceeded sales targets during Black Friday, one of retail's highest-pressure trading periods, by delivering personalised styling consultations that increased units per transaction (UPT) above the team benchmark.

## SELECTED PROJECTS

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| <b>Tokyo Drift - Cultural Ethnography</b><br>Produced a 10,000-word ethnography from three weeks of Tokyo fieldwork using participant observation, formal and semi-structured interviews, fieldnotes, and reflective journaling; analysed how sound, fashion, and movement shape subcultural identity. | <b>Tokyo   2025</b> |
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| <b>Bekaa - Hospitality Brand Strategy</b><br>Combined cultural, competitor, and market research with audience definition, operational planning, and financial planning to develop positioning and recommendations for a differentiated listening-bar concept. | <b>Independent MA   2025</b> |
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## SKILLS AND COMPETENCIES

**Languages:** English (fluent), French (advanced), Arabic - Lebanese dialect (intermediate)

**Transferable Skills:** Team leadership, project management, cross-functional collaboration, client-facing communication, budget awareness

**Creative Competencies:** Art direction, visual storytelling, brand identity, creative strategy, campaign development, photoshoot production, social media strategy, content planning, trend research, cultural analysis